

1. Deaths per 1000 People:

1980

- Age 15-24: 1.1543 deaths per 1000 people
- Age 25-44: 1.7328 deaths per 1000 people
- Age 45-64: 9.5588 deaths per 1000 people

2016:

- Age 15-24: 0.7489 deaths per 1000 people
- Age 25-44: 1.5902 deaths per 1000 people
- Age 45-64: 6.4052 deaths per 1000 people

One of the main causes for why there were so many deaths for people between the ages of 45-64 in 1980 is because of the opioid crisis. In the 1980's the consumption of opioid drugs was common for this age group as people didn't the harsh effects of these drugs weren't as well known.

<https://injuryfacts.nsc.org/all-injuries/historical-preventable-fatality-trends/deaths-by-age-group/>

2. Diseases of the Heart

1980:

- Age 25-44: 0.2314 deaths per 1000 people

2016:

- Age 25-44: 0.1635 deaths per 1000 people

One of the reasons why deaths due to heart disease was slightly more prevalent in the 1980's verses 2016 is because of the knowledge we have today. For example, in society today it is a very well-known fact that smoking is bad for your lungs and can lead to lung cancer and even affect your heart. In the 1980's there was less information about the negative effects of smoking, and they had less treatment options and were not as advanced technologically when it came to cardiovascular issues.

https://www.cdc.gov/pcd/issues/2016/16_0211.htm

3. Suicide

2016:

- 25-44: 0.1691 deaths per 1000 people
- 45-64: 0.1921 deaths per 1000 people

One of the reasons why the death rate due to suicide went up is because the culture today has become harsher, and people struggle more with mental health than ever before. With social media being a dominant force in people's lives in recent years, and cyberbullying at an all-time high, people from a young age are experiencing extreme bullying. Whether in person or on the internet, there is a rapid growth of teen suicide and even mental health disorders in younger generations. Even the older generations are starting to experience this as many of them have been exposed to harsh things on the internet or aren't able to get the help they need mentally and physically.

<https://www.nber.org/bh/20232/what-accounts-rise-suicide-rates-us>

4. What value might there be in thinking about death?

As a Christian, thinking about death can be a harsh reality for us, but it should also bring us comfort. Knowing that Jesus paid the ultimate price for our death so we could be reunited with Jesus forever in Heaven is the best thing we could ask for. I am reminded of a well-known verse, but its words remain true, it says "I am the way, the truth, and the life, no one comes to the Father except through me." John 3:16. God never promised us that life would be easy, and we will experience hard things, and the death of loved ones. However, God does promise that there will be no more sorrow, no more pain, and no more suffering in Heaven. In Revelation 21:4 it says, "He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more."